



remained the same.

Carlsen led the leaderboard almost wire-to-wire, barring a brief moment when Erigaisi overtook him, also handing him his sole defeat of the tournament. Carlsen, however, quickly regained his footing, leaving no doubt as to who was in control.

Wesley and Erigaisi impress

Former World Fischer Random Champion Wesley So had an impressive tournament as well. He finished third in the rapid event behind Praggnanandhaa and surged to second place in blitz.

Erigaisi, despite a strong showing, will rue his missed opportunities. Leading the blitz event after 15 rounds, he suffered a heartbreaking collapse, losing his last three games and slipping to third.

Russian resilience

In the Women's section, Russian dominance was the central theme. Aleksandra Goryachkina's **(above)** consistent play saw her capture the rapid title, while three-time World Blitz Champion Kateryna Lagno **(right)** exhibited her trademark

poise and control to win the blitz crown, both with a round to spare.

Among Indians, only Vantika Agrawal had a strong showing in both time formats.

She finished third in the rapid, while just missing out on a podium finish in blitz due to an inferior tiebreak with third-placed Goryachkina.



Final Standings – Women

Rapid

Aleksandra Goryachkina (7.5); Nana Dzagnidze (5.5); Vantika Agrawal (5); Kateryna Lagno (4.5); Harika Dronavalli (4.5); Valentina Gunina (4.5); Divya Deshmukh (3.5); R. Vaishali (3.5); Alexandra Kosteniuk (3.5); Koneru Humpy (3).

Blitz

Kateryna Lagno (11.5); Valentina Gunina (11); Aleksandra Goryachkina (9.5); Vantika Agrawal (9.5); Alexandra Kosteniuk (9); Koneru Humpy (9); Harika Dronavalli (8.5); R. Vaishali (8); Divya Deshmukh (7.5); Nana Dzagnidze (6.5).

